Outpost - Platform for Founders

Scope Document for T-Hub

This document is the single source of truth for the Outpost engagement. It is written for everyone with a stake in the build: T-Hub, the design team, the development team, and The Product Folks. If something is not in this document, it is not in scope. If this document changes, every stakeholder gets the new version.

Scope

Outpost is one web platform where a founder in T-Hub's ecosystem can find the people, opportunities and resources they need to build their startup, in one place, immediately after signing up.

At the centre sits the founder's profile, which we call the member spine. Every module reads from it and, over time, writes back to it, so the platform knows more about the founder with every action they take. Around the spine sit the modules, each solving one recurring founder need: booking a mentor, finding a corporate challenge to pitch for, checking which grants they can apply for, claiming credits and tools, and finding a first hire. An AI layer runs across the modules to help the founder find exactly what they are looking for.

The platform ships in two versions within this one engagement. V1 puts the foundation and the three supply-led modules live. V2 adds the benefits, hiring and spotlight modules, and enriches the profile. Both versions are in scope. Anything marked "parked" in this document is not.

Member spine (Profile)

★ *The identity every module is built on*

Every module needs an identity behind it. A mentor booking comes from a founder. A challenge response comes from a startup. A claimed credit belongs to an account. The member spine is the layer that holds all of this: a founder signs up, creates a profile, and that identity is what every module uses to show the right things and make introductions.

What it does (V1)	● Sign Up and Sign In with Google, LinkedIn, or email and password. ● Email sign-up includes verification and password reset. ● One account per founder, regardless of sign-in method. ● First sign-in runs a short onboarding flow: founder name, startup name, startup stage (dropdown, values set by T-Hub), sector (dropdown), city, website (optional). ● Required fields cannot be skipped. Everything is editable later. ● Profile page: view and edit the above, manage sign-in details. ● Every other module references this account. Mentor bookings, challenge connections and claimed offers are tied to the founder record. ● This is what lets the platform personalise what it shows and, later, enrich the profile from those actions.
What it does (V2)	● Profile grows into an enriched profile. ● Pitch deck upload: PDF, size limit set during build, founder can replace or remove it. ● Free-text bio. ● Links: LinkedIn, X, and any other URL. ● Visibility of the enriched profile is decided in design. Default assumption: visible to the founder and to T-Hub through admin, and used by Founder of the Day. ● Data model built so future modules can attach records to the profile (applications, bookings, check-ins) without migrating the spine.
Key screens	Sign up / sign in. Onboarding (stage, sector, city, website). Profile view and edit (V1). Enriched profile with pitch deck, bio and links (V2).
Parked	Parsed pitch deck, karma points, verified badges, and other profile features not relevant to V1 or V2.

The binding layer: Integrated AI

★ *Present in every module, not a module of its own*

AI is not a separate module on Outpost. It is integrated throughout the platform at the right places to be the helping hand the founder needs. It knows the founder from the member spine and helps them find exactly what they are looking for inside each module, whether that is the right mentor, the right challenge or the right grant.

V1 & V2	Integrated into all V1 & V2 modules: Primarily via smarter AI recommendations in search, filters, details, etc.
Parked	Advanced AI features and workflows: proactive recommendations, agentic actions, etc.

Modules

Each module is deliberately lean. It does one job well. It is not a full standalone product trying to compete with the biggest tool in its category. V1 modules ship in Phase 1; V2 modules ship in Phase 2.

V1 modules

1. Connect to People (Mentors)

Ships in V1 · Phase 1

The need	"I'm stuck on pricing and need thirty minutes with someone who has done it."
What it does	• Mentor listing page: one card per mentor with name, photo, headline (role and company) and expertise tags. • Filters: expertise (multi-select), plus stage and sector where mentor data supports it. • Keyword search across name, headline and expertise. • AI search results to show relevant mentors based on the founder's profile. • Paginated results. Empty state when no mentor matches. • Mentor profile page: bio, expertise tags, experience, links, and a "Book a call" button. • Booking runs on cal.com, not Outpost. Each mentor record holds a cal.com link. • "Book a call" opens that link (embed or new tab, decided in design). • Confirmations, reminders, rescheduling and cancellations all happen inside cal.com. • Outpost does not store bookings in V1 or V2. • V1: mentor records are loaded from the list T-Hub seeds. • V2: mentors can apply through a short form. Applications sit in a queue until T-Hub approves them in admin, then go live.
Key screens	Mentor listing with filters and smart search. Mentor profile. Mentor application form (V2). Empty state for no matches.

What the founder does	Browse or filter mentors by expertise, open a mentor profile, and book a call directly from the platform.
How it fills	T-Hub seeds the listing from its existing mentor network. Mentor approval through the admin layer is added in V2.
V1	Mentor listing with filters. Mentor profile. Booking managed via cal.com.
V2	Admin can approve mentors (see Admin layer).
Parked	Matching algorithm, in-platform messaging, ratings, payments, in-platform booking.

2. Corporate Challenges

Ships in V1 · Phase 1

The need	"Which corporates are looking for a startup that solves what we solve?"
What it does	● Challenge listing page: one card per challenge with corporate name and logo, title, sector or theme, deadline and status (open or closed). ● Filters: sector, theme, corporate, status. ● Keyword search across title and problem statement. ● AI search results to show relevant challenges based on the founder's profile. ● Sort by newest or by deadline. ● Closed challenges stay browsable but are marked closed. ● Challenge detail page (where the corporate has supplied one): problem statement, what the corporate is looking for, eligibility, timeline and deadline, what is on offer (pilot, POC, partnership), and the connect action. ● Challenges without a detail page show the card information and the connect action only. ● "Apply now" takes them to a submission form for the corporate challenge, this could be outside Outpost. ● No in-platform pitching, scoring or submission tracking. Everything after the introduction happens outside the platform. ● Admin creates, edits, publishes, unpublishes and closes challenges. A challenge closes automatically when its deadline passes.
Key screens	Challenge listing with filters, smart search and sort. Challenge detail. Connect-with-corporate form and confirmation. Empty state.

What the founder does	Browse, filter and search challenges, read the detail page, and connect with the corporate behind it. Find relevant challenges based on their profile.
How it fills	T-Hub adds and edits challenges through the admin layer, bringing its corporate relationships to seed the first ones.
V1	Discovery listing with filters and search. Detail page per challenge where available. A way to connect with the corporate.
Parked	Match scoring, in-platform pitching, submission tracking.

3. Grants & Schemes

Ships in V1 · Phase 1

The need	"Which government grants can I actually apply for right now?"
What it does	● Directory page: one card per grant or scheme with name, issuing body (central, state or other), type (grant, subsidy, scheme, incentive), amount or range where known, eligible stages, sectors and deadline (a date or "rolling"). ● Filters: issuing body, type, stage, sector, amount band, deadline (open now, closing this month, rolling). ● Keyword search across name, issuing body and summary. ● AI search results to show relevant grants based on the founder's profile. ● Expired entries drop off the default view. A filter can bring them back. ● Detail page per entry: short summary in T-Hub's words, eligibility, what is funded, amount, and a summary of how to apply. ● A prominent link to the source page where the actual application lives. ● The original grant text is not republished. The detail page points to the source with credit. ● Admin creates, edits and marks entries expired. ● No eligibility checking against the founder's profile and no in-platform application. Both are parked.
Key screens	Grants directory with filters and search. Grant detail with link to source. Empty state.
What the founder does	Browse and filter the directory, open a grant, and follow the link to the source to apply.
How it fills	T-Hub and populate the directory through the admin layer. T-Hub maintains it after handover.

V1	Browsable and filterable directory of all available grants and schemes. Links to the source page with instructions.
Parked	Eligibility engine, hyper-personalised grant matching, in-platform application, status tracking.

4. Admin layer

Ships in V1, extended in V2

The need	T-Hub's need: "We need to keep the platform current without asking the dev team every time."
What it does	● A separate admin area on the same platform, reachable only by T-Hub admin accounts. ● V1 ships with a single admin role. Role management and multiple sign-ins are parked, so one set of credentials is shared by the T-Hub team running the platform. ● V1 content types: grants and schemes, corporate challenges, partners, offers. ● For each content type: list, create, edit, publish, unpublish. Forms match the fields shown on the founder-facing side, plus a published toggle and, where relevant, a deadline or expiry date. ● Partners and offers are entered in V1 so T-Hub can load them before T-Hub Partner program goes live in V2. ● V1 mentor records are loaded from T-Hub's seed list during the build. ● V2: mentor approval queue (pending, approved, rejected) fed by the mentor application form. Admin can edit or remove live mentors. ● V2: Founder of the Day scheduler. Pick a founder from the member list, set the date, see the upcoming queue.
Key screens	Admin sign-in. Content lists and edit forms for grants, challenges, partners and offers (V1). Mentor approval queue and Founder of the Day scheduler (V2).
What the founder does	Not applicable. This module is used by T-Hub, not founders.
How it fills	T-Hub operates it. Access is set up at V1 hand-off.
V1	An interface to add and edit grants, challenges, partners and offers.
V2	Ability to approve mentors and pick the Founder of the Day.
Parked	Analytics, approval workflows, role management, multiple sign-ins.

V2 modules

5. T-Hub Partner Program (Benefits)

Ships in V2 · Phase 2

The need	"What credits and tools can I get through T-Hub, and how do I claim them?"
What it does	● Benefits page listing every credit, tool and partner offer available to T-Hub founders. ● One card per offer with partner logo, offer headline (for example, credits worth a stated amount, or a free plan for a period), category (cloud, developer tools, business tools, services) and a short eligibility note. ● A featured section at the top promotes value partners such as AWS and Google. ● Filters: category, partner. Keyword search across partner name and offer headline. ● AI search results and smart listing to show relevant benefits based on the founder's profile. ● Expired offers drop off the default view. ● Offer detail page: what the founder gets, who is eligible, how to claim (steps plus a link, code or contact, depending on the partner), and validity. ● Claiming happens with the partner, not on Outpost. The platform gives the instructions and the link. ● No in-app redemption and no tiers. ● Admin manages partners and offers. Each offer is tied to a partner record, so a partner with several offers appears once.
Key screens	Benefits listing with featured partners, filters and search. Offer detail with how to claim. Empty state.
What the founder does	Browse the offers, open one, and follow the claim instructions.
How it fills	T-Hub brings its partner offers and adds them through the admin layer.
V2	Listicle of credits, tools and partner offers, each showing the offer and how to claim it. Value partners promoted.
Parked	In-app redemption and tiers.

6. Hiring / Talent pool

Ships in V2 · Phase 2

The need	"I need my first two hires and I don't want to sift through a job board."
What it does	• Candidate directory, visible only to signed-in founders. • One card per candidate with name, role they are looking for, skills, experience level, location and availability (immediate, on notice period, open to offers). • Filters: role, skills, experience level, location, availability. • Keyword search across name, role and skills. • Smart recommendations based on founder's profile. • Candidate resume page: resume and details of the candidate. • Founders reach out directly using those details. • No in-platform messaging, job posting or application flow. • Candidate records come from T-Hub's pool, loaded by import during the build. Admin form to add or edit individual candidates.
Key screens	Candidate directory with filters and search. Candidate resume page. Empty state. A form for candidates to fill their data.
What the founder does	Search and filter candidates, open a profile, and contact the candidate directly.
How it fills	T-Hub supplies the candidate pool.
V2	Directory of candidates, searchable and filterable. Founders reach out directly using listed contact details.
Parked	AI search and ranking, job posting, application flow.

7. Founder of the Week

Ships in V2 · Phase 2

The need	T-Hub's need: "We want to shine a light on one founder at a time, and we want to choose who."

What it does	• A spotlight slot on the Outpost homepage featuring one founder at a time. • Shows photo, name, startup, a one-line description, and a link to more about them (the enriched profile, subject to the visibility decision made in design). • T-Hub picks who is featured and when, through the admin scheduler. • The slot switches automatically at the start of each day (IST) to the scheduled founder. • If no founder is scheduled for a day, the most recent one stays up. • No automation in choosing founders. The human in the loop is the point. Automation fed by the Check-in engine is parked.
Key screens	Homepage spotlight slot. Founder of the Week scheduler in admin (see Admin layer).
What the founder does	Sees the featured founder on the homepage. May be featured themselves.
How it fills	T-Hub picks founders in advance through the admin layer.
V2	A spotlight slot on the homepage. Ability for T-Hub to pick founders in advance.
Parked	Automation, fed by the Check-in engine.

Larger Vision

Outpost becomes the operating layer for T-Hub's founder ecosystem, with T-Hub as the trusted name behind it. The modules above are the first steps on a longer path.

- **A profile that gets richer with every action.** Uploading a pitch deck, applying for a grant, being mentored, hiring: each of these enriches the member spine. Eventually this enables personalisation across the whole platform.
- **Recommendation-led matching.** Mentor connections move from filtered listing to recommendation, with feedback loops that improve the match over time.
- **A two-way corporate marketplace.** Corporates find the startups already solving their problem, and startups find the corporates who need them. No current product solves this well, which makes it Outpost's biggest differentiator.
- **A fund-matching system.** Instead of a directory, a system that tells a founder what they are eligible for and guides them through the application.

- **Benefits, hiring and spotlight, all in one place.** Founders claim credits in-app, find first hires from T-Hub's pool with AI-ranked search, and get featured through an automated pipeline fed by monthly check-ins.
- **A full admin layer.** A CMS with analytics, approvals and roles, so T-Hub can run the platform at scale.
- **New modules on the same foundation.** Find Your Room (curated peer groups moderated by T-Hub), Pitch Score (a ready-or-not signal on the deck, and introductions to the next three VCs) and the Check-in engine (monthly founder updates that keep T-Hub and investors informed) can all be added later without rebuilding what V1 and V2 put in place.
- **AI that acts, not just finds.** Proactive recommendations, agentic actions and personalised nudges, once the platform knows enough about each founder to make them useful.

Out of scope

The following are explicitly not part of V1 or V2. They are listed here so there is no ambiguity for procurement, design or development. Any of them can be scoped as a separate engagement after handover.

Area	**Parked for now**
Member spine	Parsed pitch deck, karma points, verified badges
Connect to People	Sophisticated matching algorithm, in-platform messaging, ratings, payments, in-platform booking
Corporate Challenges	Match scoring, in-platform pitching, submission tracking
Grants & Schemes	Eligibility engine, in-platform application, status tracking
T-Hub Partner Program	In-app redemption and tiers
Hiring / Talent pool	Job posting, application flow
Founder of the Day	Automation fed by the Check-in engine
Admin layer	Analytics, approval workflows, role management
Integrated AI	Proactive recommendations, agentic actions, personalised nudges

Find Your Room	Whole module
Pitch Score	Whole module
Check-in engine	Whole module